

Get started with Claude

Make your first API call to Claude and build a simple web search assistant

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Prerequisites

- An Anthropic [Console account](#)
- An [API key](#)

Call the API

cURL Python TypeScript Java

1 Set your API key

Get your API key at the [Claude Console](#) and set it as an environment variable:

```
export ANTHROPIC_API_KEY='your-api-key-here'
```

2 Make your first API call

Run this command to create a simple web search assistant:

```
-H "x-api-key: $ANTHROPIC_API_KEY" \  
-H "anthropic-version: 2023-06-01" \  
-d '{  
  "model": "claude-sonnet-4-5",  
  "max_tokens": 1000,  
  "messages": [  
    {  
      "role": "user",  
      "content": "What should I search for to find the latest developments in rene  
    }  
  ]  
'
```

Example output:

```
{  
  "id": "msg_01HCDu5LRGeP2o7s2xGmxyx8",  
  "type": "message",  
  "role": "assistant",  
  "content": [  
    {  
      "type": "text",  
      "text": "Here are some effective search strategies to find the latest renewabl  
    }  
  ],  
  "model": "claude-sonnet-4-5",  
  "stop_reason": "end_turn",  
  "usage": {  
    "input_tokens": 21,  
    "output_tokens": 305  
  }  
}
```

Next steps

Now that you have made your first Claude API request, it's time to explore what else is possible:



Working with Messages



Features Overview



Client SDKs

Discover Anthropic client libraries.



Claude Cookbook ↗

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- Help and security
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- Terms of service: Consumer
- Usage policy